

Peterson's Guide to *Competitive Colleges* covers the most competitive schools. Their tougher-than-tough list—those colleges that accept fewer than half of their applicants—includes Amherst, Bowdoin, Cal Tech, Haverford, Swarthmore, and Tufts. But their tougher-than-tough list also includes seventeen public institutions. Among them are the University of Virginia (Charlottesville), the College of William and Mary (Williamsburg), Cal Poly (San Luis Obispo), the University of Florida (Gainesville), and the University of North Carolina (Chapel Hill).

Some private colleges excel and some don't. Some public colleges excel and some don't. But one thing is certain: public colleges cost less, usually a lot less. In a public college or university, students can earn enough to cover tuition, fees, books, and living costs in just three months of summer work.

The College Board figure of \$1,500 a year applies to commuting students. That's why it's so important to establish residency where Johnny is to go to college. Let working parents worry about saving money for Johnny's college education. As retired parents you do something almost as important. You *move* judiciously. You make sure you live in a state that runs a public university that's right for Johnny. If you can't decide what public university is right for Johnny, move to North Carolina or Texas. Both of those states offer low-cost living. Yet both states are renowned for their extensive, high-quality public university systems. Both the University of North Carolina (Chapel Hill) and the University of Texas (Austin) appear in Peterson's Guide to *Competitive Colleges*. Those top-notch universities are backed up by scores of other state universities, colleges, junior colleges, and technical schools. Johnny's bound to find a place that's right for him.

What if Johnny's a truly gifted youngster who thrives in a strong academic environment, or has wanted to go to MIT since he built a mainframe computer at age 6 and a first, cute little nuclear device at age 12? It could be a crime to take Johnny out of Beverly Hills High and put him in a small